

STATE OF OKLAHOMA

2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE
FOR ENGROSSED
SENATE BILL NO. 1531

By: Haste of the Senate

and

Miller of the House

COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE

An Act relating to aerospace, aircraft, and aviation infrastructure; amending 3 O.S. 2021, Section 421, as last amended by Section 3, Chapter 237, O.S.L. 2025 (3 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 421), which relates to the clearinghouse for unmanned aircraft systems; authorizing the Oklahoma Department of Aerospace and Aeronautics to take certain actions; providing for the promulgation of rules; and providing an effective date.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 3 O.S. 2021, Section 421, as last amended by Section 3, Chapter 237, O.S.L. 2025 (3 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 421), is amended to read as follows:

Section 421. A. The Oklahoma Department of Aerospace and Aeronautics is hereby established as the clearinghouse for unmanned aircraft systems (UAS) and advanced air mobility (AAM) in this state

1 and shall be designated as the agency of this state for the
2 promotion, enhancement, and development of UAS and AAM as well as
3 any associated infrastructure necessary to ensure the safe
4 integration and use of this new technology within the state. The
5 purpose of this clearinghouse is to create a partnership between
6 those entities that currently operate UAS, those that desire to use
7 this technology in the future, and other entities that can support
8 the research and development of UAS to ensure that this state can
9 more effectively respond to the needs of this critical sector of the
10 aviation and aerospace industry. In the operation of this
11 clearinghouse, the Department shall cooperate, assist, and
12 coordinate with the federal government, agencies of this state,
13 tribal entities, municipalities, and other persons in the
14 development of unmanned aircraft systems throughout the state to
15 ensure the acceptance of this technology and the successful
16 integration of UAS into the National Airspace System. Contingent
17 upon the availability of funds, the Oklahoma Department of Aerospace
18 and Aeronautics may use established program processes or may
19 contract with other qualified entities to carry out the duties and
20 responsibilities of the Unmanned Aircraft Systems Development Act of
21 2021.

22 B. The primary goal of the clearinghouse within the Department
23 is to establish a central point within state government to develop
24 and implement the strategy for how this state can become a leader in

1 the UAS and AAM industry. It will focus the collective resources,
2 knowledge, information, and assets within state government to ensure
3 coordinated efforts amongst all parties. The clearinghouse will
4 have the authority to:

5 1. Conduct research on what other states and localities are
6 doing insofar as their UAS rules and regulations so that it can
7 provide recommendations to ensure this state is in the best position
8 within the industry;

9 2. Organize and coordinate the application for any UAS and AAM
10 test site, integration opportunity, pilot program, or grant funding
11 on behalf of this state;

12 3. Maintain a registry of UAS being operated by state agencies,
13 except those UAS that are part of a university-affiliated research
14 program;

15 4. Maintain a registry of educational institutions that offer
16 training programs for users of UAS;

17 5. Investigate the development of, and if necessary, create a
18 statewide system plan that will provide the framework for the
19 construction, development, siting, and potential partnerships
20 required for vertiports and other infrastructure needed to integrate
21 AAM and UAS into the existing air transportation system of the
22 state;

1 6. Develop a statewide network of UAS and AAM detection systems
2 as necessary to support the safe integration of these technologies
3 into the state's existing air transportation system; ~~and~~

4 7. Create statewide or regional command, control, and radar
5 systems or centers to carry out the provisions of paragraph 6 of
6 this subsection and the Department's efforts to bring UAS and AAM
7 testing and development to the state. These systems or centers can
8 be stand-alone or in partnership with other federal, state, local,
9 tribal, or non-profit entities;

10 8. Invest in publicly owned infrastructure to support the
11 mission of the clearinghouse and the provisions of this section; and

12 9. Partner and collaborate with other states and industry
13 stakeholders as necessary to create regional or technical centers of
14 excellence with an interest in integration for UAS and AAM
15 technologies.

16 C. The Department is authorized to enter into partnerships with
17 any city or town of this state and any county or political
18 subdivision or district in this state, or any public trust thereof,
19 or any federal government entity for the purpose of investing in and
20 operating infrastructure and any other items necessary to safely and
21 effectively integrate AAM and UAS into the existing air
22 transportation system of this state as well as the testing and
23 development of these aeronautical technologies.

1 D. The Department is authorized to promulgate any rules
2 necessary to implement the provisions of the Unmanned Aircraft
3 Systems Development Act of 2021.

4 SECTION 2. This act shall become effective November 1, 2026.

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